

Preston Carey Leslie

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Dear Members of the Selection Committee,

I am writing to express my strong interest in the Energy Data Analyst I position within the Power Resources Department at Northern Wasco County PUD. As a Master of Science graduate in Quantitative Methods and Modeling, my technical portfolio focuses on engineering automated ETL/ELT pipelines, designing robust relational databases, and utilizing advanced statistical modeling to resolve complex operational friction. I am highly intentional about relocating from New York City to the Pacific Northwest to build a long-term career in a mission-driven public utility, bringing a unique blend of technical precision and community-focused dedication to your growing team.

My technical approach aligns directly with your requirement for around-the-clock (ATC) data pipelines, data reconciliation, and database integrity. Rather than relying on rigid, pre-built frameworks, I specialize in auditing data for systemic staying power. For instance, during a massive multi-layer data warehouse integration project utilizing municipal datasets, my team discovered that several key historical variables lacked long-term continuity. Instead of allowing downstream analysis to break, I audited the data architecture and adapted our Kimball dimensional star schema to prioritize conformed dimensions with proven historical stability. This meticulous approach to schema design and data validation ensures that the automated pipelines I build remain resilient against data degradation.

Furthermore, my academic and professional background has trained me to handle highly volatile, real-world datasets where structural anomalies threaten model accuracy, a skill set directly transferable to fluctuating electric load data. For example, during an analytical evaluation of public health matrices, an initial Poisson regression model completely failed to predict a massive geographic outlier: ZIP 11370, which covers a major regional correctional facility. Instead of deleting this critical data point or allowing the extreme variance to poison the standard regional baseline, I engineered a categorical dummy variable to segment the model. This strategic adjustment successfully isolated the facility's unique operational trend line, stabilized the overall statistical pipeline across 186 conformed geographic zones, and provided a highly accurate framework for evaluating prediction versus reality. I am eager to apply this same level of rigorous anomaly diagnosis to the PUD's hourly, weekly, and monthly counterparty settlement and load reconciliation reports.

Beyond engineering pipelines, I understand that data is only as valuable as an organization's ability to act on it. Throughout my five years at Callen-Lorde, I frequently acted as an operational bridge between technical infrastructure and non-technical stakeholders. As an elected Union Delegate and Lead Patient Care Associate, I regularly synthesized frontline feedback, conducted compliance audits of user logic during an enterprise-wide system migration, and presented clear status insights to senior management. I learned early in my career to communicate complex technical limitations in the plain language of operational efficiency and long-term sustainability, a philosophy I developed when designing and pitching resource optimization frameworks directly to executive leadership.

Northern Wasco County PUD's commitment to providing reliable, cost-effective power while fostering a positive, positive-impact environment deeply resonates with my professional core values. I am incredibly eager to bring my Python, SQL, and database modeling capabilities to the Power Resources team to help streamline your data integrations, automate KPI dashboards, and support your critical resource planning.

Thank you for your time, consideration, and review of my application materials. I look forward to the possibility of discussing how my quantitative portfolio can serve the customers and goals of the District.

Sincerely,

Preston Carey Leslie

